

	x	y	z
x	$\text{var}(x)$	$\text{cov}(x, y)$	$\text{cov}(x, z)$
y	$\text{cov}(y, x)$	$\text{var}(y)$	$\text{cov}(y, z)$
z	$\text{cov}(z, x)$	$\text{cov}(z, y)$	$\text{var}(z)$

diagonal: the variance of each column (the spread)

off the diagonal: the covariance of each pair (the orientation);
same colour = same value, so the matrix is symmetric